

Technical Artist – Jordan Latta

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Portfolio Link: <https://jlatte64.github.io/portfolio/>

Professional Summary

Technical Artist with two shipped titles and credit on the *God of War* franchise. Specializes in shader creation, GPU-driven rendering, and optimization across platforms to bridge complex technical requirements with unique artistic visions. Proven expertise working cross-disciplinary to solve deep, technical problems and support art and engineering pipelines.

Professional Experience

Technical Artist | Mega Cat Studios (2024-Present)

- Owned and engineered custom GPU-driven rendering systems using C# and Unity's Scriptable Render Pipeline (SRP) to achieve visuals and performance beyond default engine capabilities.
- Authored, optimized, and maintained shaders, models, materials and textures to serve evolving visual styles and improve performance across platforms.
- Established and documented asset pipelines from creation to management, training up peers and supporting teams throughout production.
- Collaborated with programmers, artists, and designers to build tools—including a custom lighting system and grass creation system—to ensure smooth art and engineering pipelines.

God of War: Sons of Sparta | Technical Artist

- Engineered and maintained a custom 2D lighting system and supporting tool to serve a team of 20+ artists; leveraged the GPU stencil buffer and multiple render targets to save massive light-computation CPU overhead.
- Built the core, game-wide sprite shader suite underpinning environments and characters, taking advantage of static batching and GPU instancing to optimize draw call count on PS5.
- Developed 13 shaders and materials for key environment visuals including swaying foliage, pixel-perfect running water, reflections, and dynamic lights.

Backyard Baseball | Technical Artist

- Headed R&D to develop a lightweight GPU-driven grass renderer handling 1M+ tris in one draw call—using async GPU compute, custom data structures, and Nvidia Nsight Graphics—to mitigate pipeline stalls across platforms.
- Combined environment asset meshes, materials, and textures to fit within memory budgets on Nintendo Switch, reducing batch count by 50% and memory usage by 75%.
- Mentored peers on lighting workflows, asset integration, and optimization techniques throughout production.

Education

Michigan State University | B.A. in Games & Interactive Media (2019-2023)

Minor in Game Design & Development

Skills

- Unity:** C# Scripting, Universal Render Pipeline/Scriptable Render Pipeline (SRP)
- Unreal Engine 5:** (Learning) Blueprints
- Shader Creation:** HLSL, Shader Graph
- Performance Optimization:** LODs, VRAM Budgeting, Draw-Call Reduction
- Performance Profiling:** Unity Profiler, RenderDoc, Nvidia Nsight
- PBR Workflow & Material Pipelines**
- Graphics & Rendering:** Compute Shaders, Real-time Rendering, Lighting & Global Illumination, VFX & GPU Particle systems
- Blender:** 3D Sculpting, Modeling, UV Mapping, Rendering
- Maya:** Animation, Rigging fundamentals
- Source Control:** Git, Perforce

Hobbies

- Computer Hardware/Architecture
- Culinary Arts & Food Science
- Foraging & Fermentation
- Digital Art
- Piano (self-taught)

Languages

- English
- German